

INSURANCE: WHAT YOU NEED AND WHAT YOU DON'T

Finding the Right Policies and Skipping Coverage You Can Do Without

FOR MOST OF US, there are two classes of insurance: insurance we have too much of and insurance we have too little of. Into the first category goes the life insurance policy you were talked into buying when you graduated from college and the credit protection you signed up for when you got your Visa or MasterCard. Into the second group goes the renters insurance you never even thought about purchasing and the health insurance you figure is too expensive and can get by without. This chapter will help you decide how much protection you should have, if any, in each of the basic categories: health, auto, disability, home, and life. It will alert you to types of policies to avoid, show you how to maximize insurance-related benefits from your employer, and offer you advice on how to find the least expensive comprehensive policies.

No matter what type of insurance you think you need, read the first three sections—"Getting the Best Deal," "Shopping for Insurance," and "Making the Most of Your Employer's Plans." Then you can skip around and read about only the type of insurance you need.